OFFICEAIM KNOWLEDGE BASE: TECHNICAL SUPPORT TECH

1. THE STABILIZATION PROTOCOL (DE-ESCALATION)

Never blame the user. Lower frustration and buy time.

- **Acknowledge + Confirm Impact:** "Got it — you can't log in and it's blocking your work. We'll get you back in."
- **Set a Tight Plan:** "I'll ask 3 quick questions, then we'll try 2 targeted fixes."
- **Avoid Blame:** Don't say "you entered the wrong password." Say "we'll verify credentials and access path."
- **The Tracking Script:** "You won't need to repeat steps — I'm tracking what we've tried."

2. TRIAGE CATEGORIES (BUCKETING THE ISSUE)

Always categorize the issue before digging deep:

- **A. "Invalid username/password":** Wrong creds, cached password manager, lockout, or IdP mismatch.
- **B. "Account locked / Too many attempts":** Brute force protection, or background app stuck in a retry loop.
- **C. MFA Problems:** Time drift on authenticator, push fatigue, SMS delivery failure.
- **D. SSO / OAuth / SAML Errors:** Redirect loops, "app not assigned", cookie issues, clock skew.
- **E. Device/Network Specific:** Works for some, not others. Extension interference, VPN/DNS block, MDM policy.

3. THE FAST, HIGH-SUCCESS CHECKS

Do these before pulling server logs:

1. **Verify Location:** Ensure they are using the Enterprise SSO URL, not the consumer login page.
2. **Session Reset:** Private/Incognito window -> attempt login. If it works, clear site data/cookies.
3. **Network/Path:** Switch from Wi-Fi to mobile hotspot. Disconnect/Reconnect VPN.
4. **Manual Entry:** Ask them to type the password manually once (no autofill). Check caps lock.

4. DEEP TROUBLESHOOTING BRANCHES

MFA Failures

- **TOTP wrong:** Confirm phone time is set to "Automatic" (time drift breaks TOTP). Resync

code.
- **Push not showing:** Check battery optimization killing background apps.
- **SMS missing:** Verify carrier blocks or country codes.

SSO / SAML Errors

- **"State mismatch":** Usually a cookie, storage, or aggressive browser extension issue.
- **"Invalid audience":** Misconfigured app identifiers between IdP and Service Provider.
- **"App not assigned":** Check Group membership in the Identity Provider (Okta, Entra, etc.).

5. RESOLUTION & PREVENTION

- Don't just verify "logged in". Verify they can perform one key action on the landing page.
- Have the user update saved credentials in their password manager immediately.
- Document the root cause and steps taken for the internal knowledge base.